ground troops should be with the Army in totality. Once again, it makes little sense to have them with the Air Force, and then start coordinating roles and tasks and making joint target lists. The first lot of Apache AH went to the Air Force, and the second lot, whose delivery is expected to commence in 2024, is going to the Army. The fact that the second lot is going to the Army is an acknowledgement of the fact that AHs are more intrinsically linked to the ground battle. Why not then transfer all the AH to the Army? Sometimes in trying to please everyone, one ends up pleasing no one. A 'satisficing' solution is not the answer, and all decisions must be made on the altar of operational effectiveness. It is in this context that the role of the CDS assumes significance, to bring out the requisite synergy among the Services.

Thal Sena Bhawan

Apart from the Sena Bhawan in Central Delhi, which houses a majority of the branches that comprise the Army HQ, there are several offices spread out all over Delhi. To get all these offices under one roof, it was decided to have a separate Thal Sena Bhawan (TSB) over and above the existing Sena Bhawan, to be located in Delhi Cantt. This project had been pursued vigorously by Gen Rawat and it was now for me to carry it forward. For the TSB, the site selected was diagonally opposite the Manekshaw Centre, as one approaches Delhi Cantt from the airport to the left of NH 8, just where the road takes a sharp right turn towards Dhaula Kuan. As a first step to get the project going, we decided to have the *bhoomi poojan* and laying of the Foundation Stone done by the RM. This event was conducted on 21 February 2021. The TSB, spread over 39 acres, would be a multistoreyed building, able to accommodate around

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